The cluster took 30 minutes. The decision took 2 years.

How two regulated financial firms bought and built a security data platform, from their own slides.

New York Life
Sal Picheria · Corporate VP, Security Engineering

Vanguard
Jonathan Reitnauer · Head of Cyber Security Detection & Orchestration

STEP 1 · BUILD THE MATRIX BEFORE THE DEMOS

Data lake or SIEM? Neither.

	DATA LAKES	SIEMS
Data model	− No mature standard	~ Maturity varies
Analytics	+ Essentially limitless	− Not built for freeform
Rules	—	+ Optimized for rules
Ease of use	− High bar, SQL-style	—
Retention	+ Low-cost	− Costly
Deployment	− One cloud & region	− One cloud & region
Portability	—	− Data hard to get out
Pricing	− Unpredictable	~ Mostly ingest-based

+ Strength ~ Mixed − Trade-off

> *"Neither was a good fit for us on its own." Buying both was vetoed by leadership on cost.*

Source: NYL slide "Data Lake or SIEM?", Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026.

STEP 2 · WRITE NEEDS AS OUTCOMES

Six needs. Six answers. One acceptance test.

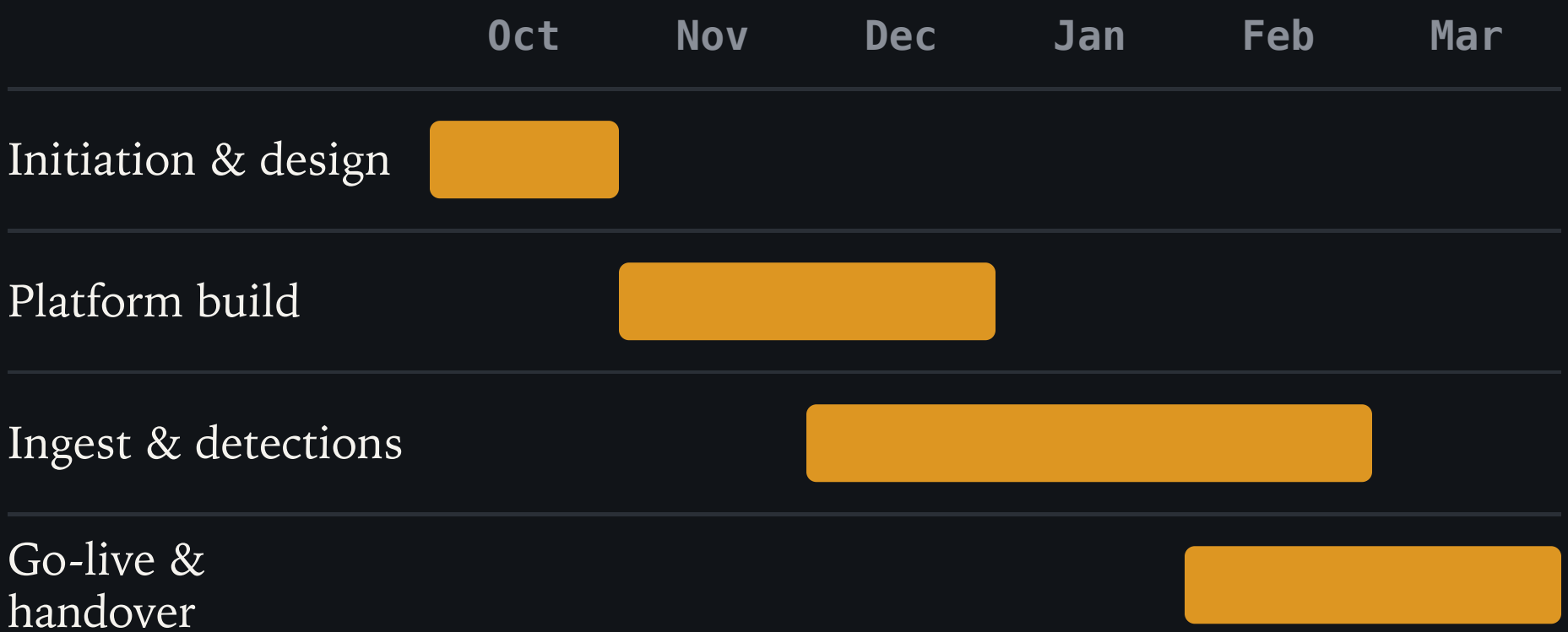
WHAT NYL NEEDED		WHAT IT GOT
Robust, stable data model	→	An open, mature common schema across all data
Freeform analytics and rules, in balance	→	Fast search and detection rules on the same data
Low barrier for non-SOC users	→	Search and dashboards any security team can use
Raw and schematized data side by side	→	Normalized fields and the original event, stored together
Deploys across regions and clouds	→	Runs where the data lives, searchable as one
Performance when needed, cost balanced	→	Tiered storage: fast where it matters, cheap elsewhere

> *None of the needs names a feature. Copy the format: it's the decision memo and the acceptance test in one.*

Source: NYL slides "What We Needed" and "What We Get with Elastic", Oct 8, 2026.

STEP 3 · THE BUILD, AS IT ACTUALLY RAN

Clusters took minutes. Decisions took months.



Milestones: kickoff Oct · **clusters online end of Dec** · all sources ingested end of Feb · go-live and old SIEM off end of Mar

20–30 min
to spin up a cluster
vs "Clusters online" at month 3

~1 month
running both SIEMs in parallel
IDC mean: 52 days

None
of the old history migrated
left in S3, old schema

Sources: NYL slide "The Implementation Journey: 6 Months" + talk; IDC Worldwide Views on SIEM Survey, Jan 2024 (Google-sponsored).

STEP 4 · RUN IT LIKE A PRODUCT

Onboarding as a pull request

1 **Request**
Team opens a ticket (or a PR)

2 **Code**
Team added to Terraform vars

3 **Automate**
Spaces, roles, RBAC and API keys deploy

4 **Access**
SSO groups map to roles, down to the field

5 **Land**
Team signs in, straight into its own space

20 teams

200 users, in a year

Source: NYL slide "A Paved Road into Elastic" + talk. No public benchmark exists for this.